HACK876 × GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION

PRIVATE EXPLORATORY BRIEF

An introduction to Hack876 and a conversation about educational fit.

The GraceKennedy Foundation has worked on access to education in Jamaica since 1982. We would like to introduce Hack876 and ask whether there is a suitable way to work together, now or later.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY THE GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION

The GraceKennedy Foundation has worked on access to education in Jamaica since 1982.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

An introduction, and an honest answer on whether an event like Hack876 could ever fit the Foundation's education work.

No funding request in this brief

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

It tells us whether to plan a school-linked activity or an application in a later cycle, or to look elsewhere.

WHAT WE HOPE TO LEARN

Whether a route exists, what it would require, and who to speak with.

THE NEXT STEP

A short reply to say whether a conversation is worthwhile.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

01 WHAT WE UNDERSTAND, AND WHAT WE WOULD ASK

An introduction, and a question about fit.

WHAT WE UNDERSTAND FROM THE PUBLISHED GUIDELINES

The Foundation's criteria require a registered non-governmental organisation or educational institution. Grants are not made in response to general appeals or for the hosting of conferences. The 2026 call closed on April 30, 2026. We do not assume Hack876 is eligible.

WHY THE GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION

The Foundation was established in 1982 to mark the 60th anniversary of GraceKennedy & Company Limited.[3]

Over three decades it has invested some US$1 million in scholarships, at institutions including the University of the West Indies and the University of Technology.[2]

In 2016 it funded an early childhood education STEAM pilot project.[3]

WHAT WE WOULD LIKE TO ASK

- ✓ **Is there a future or separate route that could suit an event like this?**
- ✓ **Would a school-linked activity, led with a partner school, be a better fit?**
- ✓ **Are educational materials something the Foundation would consider?**
- ✓ **Who is the right person to speak with, and when?**

Areas a conversation could cover: materials, equipment, programming. These are ideas to explore. None is an agreed activity or a funding request.

This brief is not an application and does not assume Hack876 is eligible for funding. It asks whether a suitable route exists.

SOURCES

1. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: Information on Grants." gracekennedy.com/information-on-grants/

2. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: Contribution to Education." gracekennedy.com/gk-foundation-contribution-to-education/

3. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: History." gracekennedy.com/gk-foundation-history/

A private exploratory brief prepared for the team at the GraceKennedy Foundation.